Cornell University

ROPER CENTER

31094715
USNBCWSJ1991-AUG

Country: United States

Title: NBC News/Wall Street Journal Poll: Soviet Union

Survey Organizations: Hart-Teeter Research Companies

Sponsors: NBC News; Wall Street Journal

Field Dates: August 28, 1991

Sample: National Sample of Registered Voters

Sample Size: 800

Interview Modes: Telephone Interview

Weight Location: Columns 90-98 (xx.xxxxxxx)

Please note that data provided by the Roper Center for Public Opinion Research may not be re-disseminated without written permission. The results of any analyses conducted on the data may, however, be published with appropriate acknowledgments and source citation.

HART-TEETER
1724 Connecticut Avenue, NW
Washington, DC 20009
(202) 234-5570

Interviews: 800 Respondents
Date: August 28, 1991

48 Male
52 Female
[5]

FINAL

Study #4020
NBC News/WSJ
August 1991

AREA [6] [7] | TYPE [8] | SAMPLE POINT [9] [10] [11] | FORM [12] | August DATE [13] [14] 1991

TIME STARTED [15] [16] [17] [18]

Be sure to use four digits to fill in time; for example, "09:00."

Hello, my name is _____ and I'm calling from Hart-Teeter for NBC News and *The Wall Street Journal*. We're conducting a confidential poll of public opinion across the country. Of the people living in your household who are at least 18 years old, including those who are not home right now, can you tell me who had the most recent birthday? (IF PERSON DOESN'T KNOW ALL THE BIRTHDAYS, SAY:) Well, of the ones you do know, who had the last birthday? May I speak to that person please? (IF PERSON WITH MOST RECENT BIRTHDAY IS NOT HOME, FIND OUT WHEN HE/SHE WILL RETURN AND MAKE AN APPOINTMENT TO CALL BACK.)

(IF RESPONDENT INDICATES THAT HE/SHE IS THE ONE WITH THE MOST RECENT BIRTHDAY, SAY:) Here is my first question. (PROCEED IMMEDIATELY TO QUESTION #1--DO NOT PAUSE.)

(IF RESPONDENT INDICATES THAT HE/SHE IS NOT THE ONE TO HAVE THE MOST RECENT BIRTHDAY, ASK TO SPEAK TO THE PERSON WHO DID. AFTER RESPONDENT COMES TO THE PHONE, SAY:)

> Hello, my name is _____ and I'm calling from Hart-Teeter for NBC News and *The Wall Street Journal*. We're conducting a confidential poll of public opinion across the country. Are you at least 18 years old and the person with the most recent birthday of all the adults living in this household? (IF "YES," SAY:) Here is my first question. (PROCEED IMMEDIATELY TO QUESTION #1--DO NOT PAUSE.)

1. Are you currently registered to vote in the precinct or election district where you now live, or haven't you had a chance to register yet?

Yes	100	**CONTINUE**	[19]
No	-	**TERMINATE AND DO**	
Not sure	-	**NOT COUNT**	

2. All in all, do you think things in the nation are generally headed in the right direction, or do you feel that things are off on the wrong track?

		7/91	6/91	5/91	3/91	2/91	12/90	10/90	9/90	7/90	5/90	4/90	3/90	1/90	11/89	9/89	
1 Right direction	41	33	40	40	55	65	28	22	45	40	42	47	44	49	41	42	[20]
2 Wrong track .	38	50	44	38	26	22	51	59	40	37	38	32	31	29	35	34	
3 Mixed (VOL) .	15	12	13	17	15	9	15	14	10	18	16	13	20	17	19	19	
4 Not sure . . .	6	5	3	5	4	4	6	5	5	5	4	8	5	5	5	5	

3. In general, do you approve or disapprove of the job George Bush is doing as president?

		7/91	6/91	5/91	3/91	2/91	1/91	12/90	10/30-31/90	10/19-21/90	
1 Approve	70	67	76	74	81	85	77	57	56	59	[21]
2 Disapprove	21	25	21	19	13	11	15	36	32	32	
3 Not sure	9	8	3	7	6	4	8	7	12	9	

9/90	7/90	5/90	4/90	3/90	1/90	11/89	9/89
75	67	72	75	69	71	67	67
15	22	21	15	19	19	22	17
10	11	7	10	12	10	11	16

4. In general, do you approve or disapprove of the way George Bush is handling the situation in the Soviet Union?

1 Approve	74	[22]
2 Disapprove	13	
3 Not sure	13	

5. Thinking about our relations with the Soviet Union over the past few years, some people say that President Bush should have done more to support President Gorbachev. Other people say that President Bush did not pay enough attention to other reform leaders in the Soviet Union such as Boris Yeltsin. Which comes closest to your point of view--that President Bush should have done more to support President Gorbachev, that he should have paid more attention to other reform leaders such as Boris Yeltsin, or do you think he balanced the various factions in the Soviet Union about right?

1 Should have done more to support Gorbachev	13	[23]
2 Should have paid more attention to other reform leaders	19	
3 Balanced factions about right	58	
4 Not sure	10	

6. Let me read you a number of areas that the president of the United States deals with as part of his job. Which one of the following do you think should be the president's most important priority? **(READ CHOICES. ACCEPT ONLY ONE RESPONSE. ROTATE ORDER OF ITEMS.)**

		7/91	
1 Dealing with the U.S. economy	36	37	[24]
2 Dealing with national security and U.S. foreign policy	12	13	
3 Dealing with domestic issues such as education, health care, and the environment	45	43	
4 Other (VOL)	1	-	
5 All of these equally (VOL)	5	6	
6 None of these (VOL)	-	-	
7 Not sure	1	1	

7. I'm going to read you the names of some people who are active in public affairs. I'd like you to rate your feelings toward each one as either very positive, somewhat positive, neutral, somewhat negative, or very negative. If you don't know the name of a person, please just say so. (READ EACH NAME AND REPEAT CHOICES. START FROM THE BOTTOM AND WORK YOUR WAY UP ON EVERY OTHER INTERVIEW.)

	(1) Very Positive	(2) Somewhat Positive	(3) Neu-tral	(4) Somewhat Negative	(5) Very Negative	(6) Don't Know Name/ Not Sure	
Mikhail Gorbachev	**20**	**45**	**20**	**9**	**3**	**3**	[25]
June 1991	16	42	22	10	7	3	
May 1991 *	13	34	25	13	7	8	
March 1991	10	32	23	17	11	7	
February 1991	7	32	30	18	8	5	
July 1990	22	43	17	8	5	5	
May 1990	19	40	19	10	6	6	
December 1989	15	36	26	11	6	6	
November 1989	13	41	20	10	8	8	
Boris Yeltsin	**21**	**29**	**20**	**9**	**3**	**18**	[26]
June 1991	8	25	19	4	1	42	
July 1990	2	10	14	5	3	66	

* Asked of one-half the respondents.

8. Do you think recent events in the Soviet Union will make the world more stable, less stable, or not really affect the stability of the world?

1 More stable	43	[27]
2 Less stable	31	
3 Not really affect the stability of the world	15	
4 Not sure	11	

9. Based on what you know, do you think President Gorbachev will or will not still be the leader of the Soviet Union one year from now?

		7/91	6/91	3/91	5/90 *	
1 Will still be the leader ..	29	53	49	42	61	[28]
2 Will not still be the leader	61	34	42	45	23	
3 Not sure	10	13	8	13	13	

* In May 1990, this question read "From what you know, do you think President Gorbachev will or will not still be the leader of the Soviet Union two years from now?"

10. Who would you like to see as the leader of the Soviet Union--**(READ CHOICES. ROTATE.)**?

		6/91[1]	
1- Mikhail Gorbachev	47	63	**[29]**
2- Boris Yeltsin	27	24	
3- Neither (VOL) ...	5	3	
4+5 - Not sure	21	11	

[1]In June, question only asked of respondents who could rate their feelings toward Gorbachev and Yeltsin. Results for August reported above based on all respondents. August figures for voters who could rate their feelings: Gorbachev (46%), Yeltsin (30%), Neither (5%), Not sure (19%).

11. Do you think that recent events in the Soviet Union do or do not signal the end of communism?

1	Do signal the end of communism	59	**[30]**
2	Do not signal the end of communism	33	
3	Not sure	8	

12a. As a result of recent events in the Soviet Union, do you think relations between the United States and the Soviet Union will get better, get worse, or stay about the same?

1	Get better	59	[31]
2	Get worse	7	
3	Stay about the same	31	
4	Not sure	3	

12b. If Boris Yeltsin becomes the leader of the Soviet Union, do you think relations between the United States and the Soviet Union will get better, get worse, or stay about the same?

1	Get better	36	[32]
2	Get worse	15	
3	Stay about the same	36	
4	Not sure	13	

13a. Do you think the Cold War between the United States and the Soviet Union is still going on, or is it mostly over?

		5/90	3/90	12/89	11/89	
1 - Still going on	34	44	41	46	46	[33]
2 - Mostly over	60	49	51	40	46	
3+4 - Not sure	6	7	8	14	8	

13b. When Ronald Reagan was president he said that the Soviet Union was an evil empire and the focus of evil in the modern world. Would you agree or disagree with this statement today?

1	Agree	24	[34]
2	Disagree	69	
3	Not sure	7	

14. If President Gorbachev is no longer the leader of the Soviet Union, do you think the Soviets could be trusted more, less, or about the same to live up to agreements between the United States and the Soviet Union?

		6/91	
1 Trusted more	11	3	**[35]**
2 Trusted less	27	37	
3 Trusted about the same	51	47	
4 Depends (VOL)	5	8	
5 Not sure	6	5	

15a. Do you think it would be better--for the United States--if the republics that form the Soviet Union remain together as one nation, or if they break apart and form separate nations?

1	Better if republics stay together	43	[36]
2	Better if republics break apart	40	
3	Both equally (VOL)	2	
4	Neither (VOL)	1	
5	Not sure	14	

15b. Do you think the United States should or should not recognize the independence of the Baltic republics of Estonia, Latvia, and Lithuania, which have been part of the Soviet Union?

1 Should recognize	76	[37]
2 Should not recognize	9	
3 Wait and see (VOL)	5	
4 Not sure	10	

16a. Do you feel that the United States should or should not help the Soviet Union to strengthen its economy?

		7/91	6/91	7/90	5/90	12/89	
1 Should	51	52	51	38	38	45	[38]
2 Should not	36	39	38	45	50	40	
3 Depends (VOL)	10	5	7	11	6	8	
4 Not sure	3	4	4	6	6	7	

16b. Would you approve or disapprove of using some funds from the U.S. defense budget to help the Soviets with their economy?

1 Approve	31	[39]
2 Disapprove	63	
3 Not sure	6	

17. Let me read you a list of several ways in which the United States could aid the Soviet Union's economy. For each one, please tell me whether you favor or oppose this idea. **(READ EACH ITEM AND REPEAT CHOICES. ROTATE.)**

	(1) Favor	(2) Oppose	(3) Not Sure	
Allow American companies to sell high-technology products to the Soviet Union even if they have potential military usage	**18**	**78**	**4**	**[40]**
June 1991	16	81	2	
December 1989	17	77	6	
Allow the Soviet Union to join international lending institutions so they could borrow more money from the West	**58**	**36**	**6**	**[41]**
June 1991	54	40	6	
December 1989	45	48	7	
Provide direct economic aid to the Soviets	**39**	**56**	**5**	**[42]**
June 1991	34	61	5	
December 1991	26	66	8	

18. Prior to the recent events in the Soviet Union, the United States had planned to reduce its military spending by about 25 percent by the year 1995. In light of the recent events in the Soviet Union, do you think the United States should reduce its military spending by a smaller amount in the neighborhood of 10 percent, by about the original amount of about 25 percent, or by a larger amount in the neighborhood of 40 to 50 percent?

1 Smaller amount of 10 percent	38	[43]
2 Original amount of about 25 percent	44	
3 Larger amount of 40 to 50 percent	13	
4 Not sure	5	

19. How concerned are you that the nuclear weapons of the Soviet Union may no longer be controlled by the leaders of the central government--extremely concerned, quite concerned, just somewhat concerned, or not that concerned?

1 Extremely concerned	35	[44]
2 Quite concerned	22	
3 Just somewhat concerned	27	
4 Not that concerned	14	
5 Not sure	2	

FACTUALS: Now I am going to ask you a few questions for statistical purposes only.

F1. In politics today, do you generally consider yourself to be very liberal, somewhat liberal, moderate, somewhat conservative, very conservative, or haven't you thought much about it?

1 Very liberal	7	[45]
2 Somewhat liberal	17	
3 Moderate	24	
4 Somewhat conservative	27	
5 Very conservative	11	
6 No thoughts	12	
7 Not sure	2	

F2. Generally speaking, do you think of yourself as a Democrat, a Republican, an Independent, or something else?

(IF "DEMOCRAT" OR "REPUBLICAN," ASK:) Would you call yourself a strong Democrat/Republican or a not very strong Democrat/Republican? (IF "NOT SURE," CODE AS "NOT STRONG DEMOCRAT/REPUBLICAN.")

(IF "INDEPENDENT," ASK:) Do you think of yourself as closer to the Republican Party, closer to the Democratic Party, or do you think of yourself as strictly Independent? (IF "NOT SURE," CODE AS "STRICTLY INDEPENDENT.")

1 Strong Democrat	16	[46]
2 Not strong Democrat	17	
3 Independent/lean Democrat	6	
4 Strictly Independent	15	
5 Independent/lean Republican	9	
6 Not strong Republican	17	
7 Strong Republican	15	
8 Other	3	
9 Refused	1	
0 Don't know/nothing	1	

F3. How old are you? (IF REFUSED, ASK:) Well, can you tell me which age group you belong to? Are you in the age group 18 to 24, 25 to 29, 30 to 34, 35 to 39, 40 to 44, 45 to 49, 50 to 54, 55 to 59, 60 to 64, or 65 and over?

1 18-24	9	6 45-49	8	[47]
2 25-29	9	7 50-54	7	
3 30-34	12	8 55-59	8	
4 35-39	11	9 60-64	7	
5 40-44	12	0 65 and over	17	
		Not sure/refused	-	

May we please have your initials for validation purposes?

[53]	[54]	[55]

Thank you for your time and cooperation.

RECORD THE FOLLOWING--DO NOT ASK!

Interview began: : a.m. p.m. (circle) **Interview ended: : a.m. p.m.** (circle)

Telephone Number--Get from Call Sheet:

AREA CODE

[56]	[57]	[58]	[59]	[60]	[61]	[62]	[63]	[64]	[65]

Caller Identification Number:

[66]	[67]	[68]	[69]

Length of Interview--Record Number of Minutes:

[70]	[71]

THIS IS A BONA FIDE INTERVIEW AND HAS BEEN OBTAINED

ACCORDING TO MY AGREEMENT WITH HART-TEETER

Interviewer's Name (PLEASE SIGN):_____

Validated By:_____ Date:_____

Validator: Record a "1" [ ]

[73]

For #4006 on

NBC News/Wall Street Journal Region Codes

REGION (col. 6-7)

(01) New England
(02) Mid-Atlantic
* (03) W.Va, Maryland, Delaware, District of Columbia
(04) South Atlantic (not incl. REGION 3)
(05) East South Central
(06) West South Central (not incl. Arkansas)
* (07) Arkansas
(08) East North Central
(09) West North Central
(10) Mountain
(11) Pacific

* Indicates differences between Peter D. Hart Associates' region breaks and those of the Census and NBC/WSJ. The region codes have been arranged in this manner to allow for maximum flexibility when working with these data.

1SINGLE COL FREQUENCIES FOR USNBCWSJ1991-AUG / NCARDS 800

0 COL +	&	-	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	BLANK	OTHER	NONBLNK	COL
1	0	0	200	600	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	1
2	0	0	198	200	101	100	100	100	1	0	0	0	0	0	800	2
3	0	0	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	0	0	800	3
4	0	0	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	0	0	800	4
5	0	0	0	385	415	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	5
6	0	0	630	170	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	6
7	0	0	50	162	116	27	119	46	80	8	134	58	0	0	800	7
8	0	0	12	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	788	0	12	8
9	0	0	69	381	42	0	0	0	1	0	0	0	307	0	493	9
10	0	0	111	76	77	79	75	77	77	75	72	80	1	0	799	10
11	0	0	86	78	84	86	84	76	85	77	67	77	0	0	800	11
12	0	0	0	600	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	200	0	600	12
13	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	13
14	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	0	800	14
15	0	0	703	68	27	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	1	0	799	15
16	0	0	21	12	1	0	0	136	204	173	148	104	1	0	799	16
17	0	0	148	100	138	146	145	119	0	2	0	1	1	0	799	17
18	0	0	243	33	35	44	40	241	31	42	52	38	1	0	799	18
19	0	0	0	800	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	19
20	0	0	0	325	302	123	50	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	20
21	0	0	0	556	170	74	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	21
22	0	0	0	595	101	104	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	22
23	0	0	0	105	152	466	77	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	23
24	0	0	0	293	92	362	7	40	2	4	0	0	0	0	800	24
25	0	0	0	161	355	162	68	25	29	0	0	0	0	0	800	25
26	0	0	0	171	233	162	67	25	142	0	0	0	0	0	800	26
27	0	0	0	346	249	118	87	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	27
28	0	0	0	231	487	82	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	28
29	0	0	0	381	215	31	38	135	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	29
30	0	0	0	471	268	61	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	30
31	0	0	0	471	54	250	25	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	31
32	0	0	0	285	124	289	102	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	32
33	0	0	0	268	482	19	31	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	33
34	0	0	0	191	555	54	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	34
35	0	0	0	92	216	403	44	45	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	35
36	0	0	0	341	320	18	9	112	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	36
37	0	0	0	609	73	42	76	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	37
38	0	0	0	411	287	80	22	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	38
39	0	0	0	246	508	46	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	39
40	0	0	0	143	626	31	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	40
41	0	0	0	465	289	46	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	41
42	0	0	0	314	443	43	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	42
43	0	0	0	301	357	101	41	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	43
44	0	0	0	279	179	211	112	19	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	44
45	0	0	0	53	137	189	218	90	95	18	0	0	0	0	800	45
46	0	0	5	129	136	49	122	70	133	126	24	6	0	0	800	46
47	0	0	144	72	77	94	79	94	59	55	64	62	0	0	800	47
48	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	48
49	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	49
50	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	50
51	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	51
52	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	52
53	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	53
54	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	54
55	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	55
56	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	56
57	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	57
58	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	58
59	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	59
60	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	60
61	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	61
62	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	62
63	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	63
64	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	64
65	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	65
66	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	66
67	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	67
68	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	68
69	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	69
70	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	70
71	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	71
72	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	72
73	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	73
74	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	74
75	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	75
76	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	76
77	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	77
78	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	78
79	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	79
80	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	80
81	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	81

1SINGLE COL FREQUENCIES FOR USNBCWSJ1991-AUG / NCARDS 800

0 COL +	&	-	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	BLANK	OTHER	NONBLNK	COL
82	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	82
83	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	83
84	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	84
85	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	85
86	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	86
87	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	87
88	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	88
89	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	0	0	89
90	0	0	283	517	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	90
91	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	800	800	91
92	0	0	438	79	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	283	0	0	800	92
93	0	0	198	134	188	77	144	0	0	0	59	0	0	0	800	93
94	0	0	136	188	0	141	203	77	0	0	55	0	0	0	800	94
95	0	0	213	55	250	0	144	0	0	59	0	79	0	0	800	95
96	0	0	136	0	141	0	203	0	77	188	55	0	0	0	800	96
97	0	0	136	55	0	0	300	121	188	0	0	0	0	0	800	97
98	0	0	215	0	0	0	144	0	188	0	176	77	0	0	800	98